BOOKS ▼

FOUND IN TRANSLATION

Arunava Sinha has launched Chowringhee Press, an imprint for books in translation

It's fair to say that literature-in-translation from Indian languages is enjoying an extended phase of cultural prominence. Writers working in Hindi, Tami, Bangla, Kannada et al are increasingly being published around the world in translation, and winning awards (the latest being the 2025 International Booker Prize for Kannada writer Banu Mushtaq and her English translator Deepa Bhasthi). In another happy development in this space, the prolific translator Arunava Sinha has started a new publishing imprint called Chowringhee Press, specifically for Indian translations. The first-ever Chowringhee Press title is Sinha's own translation of *The Laboratory*, a short novel by Rabindranath Tagore that also happens to be the last novel he ever wrote.

The first title will be Sinha's translation of *The Laboratory*, a short novel by Rabindranath Tagore

Talking about the new imprint during a telephonic interview, Sinha says, "This is an idea that had been on my mind for a couple of years now. Until now, it hadn't happened because of the investments typically required to set up a publishing house. We have now found a way to make it work without a huge initial investment."

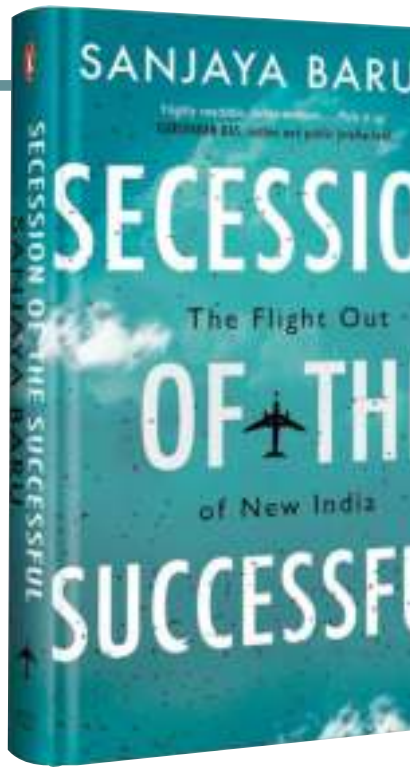
Chowringhee Press will function as an imprint of Stck Books (pronounced "Stack Books"), a self-publishing platform. The way it works is quite straightforward. In this business model, instead of pre-publishing a certain number of copies, the publisher prints copies on demand. The number of copies therefore equals the number of orders, reducing the need for a large initial investment.

Sinha said, "With the larger publishing houses, they have a lot of different kinds of books coming out at once, they have to handle large volumes. So, unless your translated book is by a really famous writer, or it's an award-winning work, it's difficult to get people's attention. What we're trying to do with Chowringhee Press is to help get readers for deserving works-in-translation, both in India and abroad." ■

—Aditya Mani Jha

THE LI

Recent releases which



SECESSION OF THE SUCCESSFUL
By Sanjaya Baru
PENGUIN/VIKING
PAGES: 320; PRICE: ₹ 799

A RIVER RUNS THROUGH IT

Saraswati is the ambitious debut novel by 27-year-old British writer Gurnaik Johal. His protagonist, a Londoner called Satnam, returns to his ancestral village in Punjab for his grandmother's funeral — to discover a long-dried well miraculously spouting water. This triggers a search for Satnam's diasporic relatives around the world, amid a politically charged campaign to revive the mythical 'lost river' Saraswati.